

MIRROR PAGE

Implementation plan for Hours 12 to 100. Four comic heroes, one narrator, two vampires: friend or villain? Reveal or kill.

Developer	Sankeerth Nara (solo)	Repository	github.com/SankeerthNara/TGC-Game-Jam (public, MIT)
Themes	Comic, Twist, Light (all three)	Engine	Godot 4.7, GDScript, Compatibility renderer, Web export
Final playtime	About 17 to 19 minutes (20 max)	Plan status	Concept locked at Hour 12. Features below are committed or marked stretch.

1. THE GAME IN ONE PARAGRAPH

A fixed **Narrator** frames four comic stories. Each level is built for one comic hero (superhero pulp, noir detective, manga ninja, pop-art space hero), whom you play, and the map is themed that way. Each level is a pitch-dark floor of 8 rooms in a random layout; only the area around your torch is lit. You finish interactive tasks to fill a progress bar, against a par time: about **2, 3, 4 and 5 minutes** for levels 1 to 4. Which tasks trigger a sabotage is hidden. Going over par makes the **next level a little easier** (fewer tasks, easier mini-games, longer timers), so the run stays about the same length. A **score** that counts tasks, sabotage stopped or suffered, hearts, deaths and the villain choices (time is only a small bonus) gives each level a rank. Two **vampires** hide in the dark and look and behave exactly the same: one is your **friend**, the other is the comic's **villain**. Which is which is pure chance, so catching one in your torchlight and choosing **REVEAL** or **KILL** is a gamble. After four levels you fight the **Narrator** in the final boss fight.

If the vampire is...		REVEAL	KILL
The friend		He becomes your ally. He no longer fears light and helps with tasks, hints and later the boss fight.	The friend dies. You lose him for the run, the Narrator reacts, and your ending and boss fight get harder.
The villain		He is unmasked and you fight him (short fight, torch beam as the weapon). Win and the sabotage stops, plus you gain a heart.	The villain dies at once and the sabotage stops, but there is no reward fight and no heart bonus.

Level	Par time	Tasks	Villain sabotage (hidden triggers)	Friend help (grows each level)
1	2:00	4	1 sabotage	Points an arrow to the nearest unfinished task.
2	3:00	6	2 sabotages	Also finishes one small task for you every so often.
3	4:00	8	2 big sabotages (2 hearts, harder fix, shorter timer)	Also adds time to sabotage timers and distracts the villain.
4	5:00	10	2 big sabotages, plus one hidden task that undoes a task you finished	Also fixes the first sabotage by himself and shields you once.

Already built and verified at Hour 12: the dark level with torch lighting and smooth 8-direction movement, a generator for random 8-room levels (4 difficulty tiers), 13 interactive task types (classic, comic, college and the original light-puzzle pages with their rule twists), a progress bar, sabotage countdowns with fix consoles, hearts, checkpoints and respawn, level and total timers, a map screen, comic UI and menus, CC0 audio, validators, unit tests and a browser build. Sabotage counts, par times, big sabotages, the hidden risky tasks and the task-undo disruption are already in the build; the vampires will attach to this system.

2. COMMITTED FEATURES FOR THE REMAINING 88 HOURS

#	Feature	What it adds	Hours
1	Fixed Narrator and four comic heroes	One narrator character (portrait, speech bubbles, text blips) comments on events through all four levels. Four original comic heroes (no existing characters) with their own costume and a small ability, and four themed levels: palette, fonts, props, room names, task skins and music (Comic).	16
2	Vampires and the Reveal / Kill choice	Two identical vampires per level wander the dark and flee from torchlight. Hold the beam on one to freeze it, then choose REVEAL or KILL. Friend or villain is random, so every choice is a gamble with four different outcomes. A short comic-panel suspense scene sells the moment (Light + Twist).	16
3	The friend ally	A revealed friend follows you and is not scared by light. His help grows each level (task arrow, finishes small tasks, extends sabotage timers, fixes a sabotage and shields you). Killed friends change the ending.	7
4	Villain fight (small fight, every level)	One reusable arena fight with four villains, each with a different attack pattern. The torch beam is the weapon; hits on you cost hearts. Kept under a minute.	10
5	Final boss: the Narrator	After level 4, a fight that lasts at least 3 minutes : three phases of about a minute each. The Narrator snuffs your torch, floods the floor with ink and attacks the interface; rotating arena mirrors bounce your beam onto his shield. Each phase ends only after its timer and its damage target are both met, so it cannot be rushed. Surviving allies help. Three endings depend on your choices (Twist).	11
6	Fourth-wall twists	The Narrator tampers with captions, the progress bar, the map and the controls for short moments.	3
7	Comic look and juice	Ink and halftone screen shader, panel-split level transitions, onomatopoeia on actions and hits.	4
8	Score and ranks	Score per level and for the run, independent of completion time: points for tasks (x1, 1.25, 1.5, 2 by level), sabotage stopped in time, hearts left and no deaths, minus sabotage that hit you, tampered tasks and deaths, plus a small under-par bonus and (when built) vampire outcomes. S/A/B/C ranks per level and overall. Best scores saved locally.	3
9	First-minute polish	30 second tutorial, controls hints, itch.io page with GIFs, README, CREDITS, AI usage log.	5
10	Balance and testing	Tuning of task difficulty and counts to hit the par times, sabotage timers and fights; outside playtests; bug fixing; web performance.	10

STRETCH (only after all of the above are playable, in this order): light puzzle rooms in the world, a torch battery with recharge lamps, reactive music. **Cut first** if time is short: stretch items, then medals, then hero abilities, then the per-hero task skins (fallback: palette swaps only), then the boss mirror phase (fallback: a two-phase boss with torch damage only).

Fixed limits: 4 levels and 4 heroes (no more), original characters only (no existing comic heroes or villains), no multiplayer, no save slots, no level editor, no new engine features.

3. ROADMAP AND MILESTONES

Hours	Work	Exit criteria (a playable build every 12 hours)
12 - 30	Plan locked. Clean-up of unused code. Narrator system (portrait, bubbles, event lines). Hero and theme for level 1. Vampire movement (patrol, flee from light, freeze in the beam). Tutorial skeleton.	Level 1 plays start to finish in the browser with the Narrator and a vampire to catch.
30 - 55	Reveal / Kill choice and all four outcomes (pure chance), friend ally with help that grows per level, villain fight (reusable arena). Heroes and themes for levels 2 and 3. First playtest of the choice at Hour 30.	Levels 1 to 3 playable with both vampires, the choice and the villain fight.
55 - 75	Level 4 hero and theme, the Narrator boss fight (three phases, mirrors, allies), endings, level transitions, fourth-wall twists, shader, medals, audio mix.	Full 17 to 19 minute run from menu through the 3 minute boss to an ending.
75 - 85	Balance pass, outside playtests, bug fixing, performance, accessibility. Feature freeze at Hour 85.	No known blocking bugs; the choice, par times and fights confirmed fair by testers.
85 - 96	Only fixes. Final web export, itch.io page and GIFs, README, CREDITS and AI usage audit, commit history check.	Public itch.io build submitted by Hour 96.
96 - 100	Safety margin. Re-verify the live itch.io build and the repository.	Strict code freeze at Hour 100.

4. HOW THE WORK IS SPLIT

- **Claude Code:** architecture, vampire AI and the choice system, fights, level generator, narrator event scripting, bug fixing, code review and merges.
- **Antigravity:** hero and villain art, level themes, UI, shaders and transitions, audio, browser (Playwright) playtests, the itch.io page.
- **ChatGPT / Codex:** tests, balance data, documentation, README and CREDITS, small isolated features.
- **Developer (Sankeerth):** all design decisions, the story, hero and villain concepts, the Narrator's script, the playtests, every merge to `main`. Design choices are logged in `docs/DESIGN_LOG.md`.
- **Method:** each tool works in its own git worktree and owns separate folders, a shared task board (`docs/TASKS.md`) tracks everything, commits are small and frequent so the history is auditable.

5. QUALITY, COMPLIANCE AND RISKS

Area	Plan
Stability	Headless unit tests for the puzzle model, level validator for every puzzle, a generator test that builds 100+ levels and checks reachability, a Playwright browser run on every milestone build.
Assets	Only free, CC0, CC BY, open-source or AI-generated assets. Everything listed in <code>CREDITS.md</code> and on the itch.io page. No paid assets.
AI disclosure	Claude Code, Antigravity and ChatGPT/Codex are used for code, art, audio and documents. Every use is logged in <code>docs/AI_USAGE.md</code> . Core design and story direction are the developer's.
Code origin	All game code is written inside the 100 hours. Only a generic empty Godot project and an editor plugin used for tooling (not part of the game) were present at the start; the plugin is credited.
Risk: a pure-chance choice feels unfair	The gamble is by design, so all four outcomes must be fun, not punishing: a suspense scene before the result, a rewarding villain fight, a meaningful friend. Playtests check testers enjoy the moment, not just the result. Fallback: level 1 always has the friend first (tutorial).
Risk: par times are missed	Task counts and mini-game difficulty are tuned from timed playtests so the four levels take about 2, 3, 4 and 5 minutes. Players who run over par get an easier next level (already built), so the whole run stays near 17 to 19 minutes with the 3 minute boss.
Risk: vampire AI is hard to tune	Keep it simple (patrol, flee from light, freeze in the beam). Fallback: the villain sabotages on a fixed schedule.
Risk: scope (largest plan item)	The vampire, choice and ally system is built first (Hours 12 to 55) and everything else is cut around it, never the other way round.
Risk: combat is not fun	Both fights reuse existing mechanics (torch light, mirrors, hearts). Attacks are slow and readable. Playtests at Hour 45 (villain fight) and Hour 70 (boss). Fallbacks: the villain fight becomes a freeze-and-catch moment, the boss drops to two phases without mirrors.
Risk: art style workload	Genres are palette, font and caption swaps over one shared set of procedural shapes. Fallback: two genres instead of four.
Risk: web performance	2D lights are limited to the hero's torch; test every milestone in a browser; keep the export under 40 MB.
Risk: AI quota limits	Work is split across three tools with a handoff note on the task board; the developer reassigns tasks to whichever tool has quota left.

6. DEFINITION OF DONE

- A public itch.io page with a playable browser build of the full 17 to 19 minute game.
- The README shows the itch.io link, setup, controls and team details. CREDITS and the AI usage log are complete.
- The final game matches this plan: all committed features present, nothing from the cut list promised.